

CSC271 Assignment 1

1. Which type of ideas do you think apply to Shyp? Why?

- Simplify and Remix. It handled multiple parts of the process for customers, pickup, packaging and choosing a carrier.

2. Which type of ideas do you think apply to Curofy? Why?

- Virtualize and Remix. It made a virtual platform for doctors to communicate and share documents.

3. Product Hunt

- Describe the idea
 - Folio is an e-reader app. It accepts different kinds of text media for you to save and listen to.
- Describe the type(s) of ideas that apply to it.
 - Simplify, Remix, and Virtualize. It takes text based files of different types and stores them in one convenient place.
- Is the idea a painkiller or a vitamin? That is, does the idea address users' needs or emotions? Why?
 - Painkiller. It makes the process more smooth/convenient. It makes a process you could do on your own in various ways and makes it user friendly, convenient, and low effort for the user.
- Is the idea easy to monetize?
 - Yes. This type of service could easily have free limits and be a paid subscription service or possibly use other forms of pay to use such as reading time if they choose to use AI voices for the voices.
- Is the idea simple and easy to describe?
 - Yes. Save something you want to listen to instead of read, and it reads it to you when you're ready to listen to it.
- Is the idea personally relevant? Are you or is someone close to you connected to the idea or the related problem?
 - Somewhat. I greatly dislike reading. I find that listening requires much less mental effort. I'm willing to listen to audio books, but not read books, so this type of thing could make me more likely to listen to scientific articles for instance which I don't currently do.
- Does the idea have a large market?

- It has a very large potential market. Anyone with a cell phone pretty much. It's a general app that focuses on preferences of the user.
- Does the idea have a legitimate secret sauce?
 - I would say probably not. The idea is straightforward enough that clones of it could be created fairly easily. The way secret sauce would be added to something like this would be by fine tuning the UI and UX to be as convenient and intuitive as possible.

A. Brainstorming

1. Brainstorm ideas of problems you want to solve with software like an app or website. Include all the problems you came up with in your document.

- Streamlining the process of making Magic The Gathering Proxy cards.

2. Brainstorm ways to solve the problems. Include all the solutions you came up with in your document.

- There are already multiple tools that help with making cards, so my goal would be to streamline them together. The current tools give tons of control, but don't provide pre-built templates. The goal would be to provide excellent quality templates so that someone can simply choose a template for each card type they like and provide a decklist. This process would take a few minutes instead of hours of learning how to build the templates manually with existing tools. Then if possible, create the final card images and import them directly into a card printing site to purchase.

3. Choose one of your ideas as your product that you will turn into a website for this course. Why did you pick this idea over the other candidates?

- To be frank, I didn't even consider anything else because this is something I legitimately want to exist. I have made many proxies in the last few weeks and the process was extremely tedious. I'd like to make the streamlined process for myself, and if I publish it publicly for others to use, great.

4. Is your idea a new one or has it existed before?

- I would not say this idea is new. There are already tools for finding card information, making proxy cards, and printing them. My idea is mainly about making the whole process easier by connecting those tools together and automating as much as possible.

5. What industry would your idea be useful in? Why? (i.e., advertising, apparel, arts, automotive, cosmetics, education, entertainment, food, etc.)

- Entertainment, specifically tabletop gaming. Magic The Gathering has a large player base, and there are plenty of people who use proxies for casual games, testing decks, custom art, or full proxy decks.

B. Product Proposal

1. Describe the product you have come up with and the type(s) of ideas that apply to it.

- My product would be a website that streamlines the process of making Magic The Gathering proxy cards. A user could provide a decklist and either upload their own art, provide image links, or use the normal card art. They would choose from pre-built templates for the different card types, and the site would prepare the cards automatically. If possible, I would also like it to create the final card images and import them directly into a card printing site.

- I think the main idea types are Simplify and Remix. Simplify because the whole point is to take a process that currently takes a long time and make it much faster. Remix because I am mainly combining existing tools into one easier process instead of trying to replace everything.

2. How is your product personally relevant to you? Are you or is someone close to you connected to the idea or the related problem?

- It is directly relevant to me because I have made a lot of proxies recently. Making one card is not a problem, but making an entire deck or a few hundred cards gets extremely repetitive. This is a tool I would actually use myself.

3. What problem will your product solve?

- It would solve how much repetitive work is involved in making a large number of proxy cards. Right now I have to find the cards, find or make the art, set up the templates, create the final images, organize the files, and then upload everything to another site for printing. Most of that does not need to be done manually every time.

4. What type of website will your product be? (i.e., blog, business, brochure, etc.)

- It would be a web application. The website itself would be the tool rather than just a page explaining or advertising something.

5. Is your product a painkiller or a vitamin? That is, does it address users' needs or emotions? Why?

- I would consider it a painkiller for people who make a lot of proxies. If someone only wants to make one card, the current process is not a big deal. If they want to make a full 100-card Commander deck, though, it becomes extremely repetitive. The point of the site would be to remove as much of that work as possible.

6. Is your product easy to monetize?

- Probably not in the form I actually want to make it. I want users to be able to fetch normal Magic card art from Scryfall, and I do not own that artwork. Because of that, I would rather keep the tool free. If I ever wanted to monetize it, I would probably remove that option and require users to provide their own images.

7. Is your product simple and easy to describe?

- Yes. Give the site a decklist and artwork, choose the card style you want, and it prepares the proxy cards for printing.

8. Who will be the likely users of your product? Does your product have a large market?

- The main users would be Magic The Gathering players who make proxies, custom art decks, Cubes, or test decks. It is obviously a smaller market than something meant for everyone, but Magic has a large enough player base that I think there would still be plenty of people who could use it.

9. Does your product have a legitimate secret sauce?

- I think the main secret sauce would be the templates and automation. The existing tools are already very powerful, but they require a lot of setup and repetitive work. My goal is to make it so the user makes the important choices once, and the website handles as much of the rest as possible.